DaySight MCP install guide

Connect your Workday tenant to Claude Desktop or the ChatGPT desktop app on Windows, and ask workforce questions in plain English.

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daysight.dev · Independent project, not affiliated with Workday, Inc., Anthropic or OpenAI.
For privacy and safety, use it with Claude Enterprise, which does not use your conversations to train models.

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Each person installs DaySight MCP on their own computer, registers their own Workday API Client (their own client ID, nothing is shared) and signs in with their own Workday account. Workday still decides what you may see: your assistant never gets more access than you have.

1. Before you start

YOU NEED	NOTES
A Windows computer	Windows is the tested platform.
Claude Desktop (current version, signed in) or the **ChatGPT desktop app**	Claude installs from one file in its settings (section 3). The ChatGPT desktop app uses its own setup program (section 4). ChatGPT on the web and phone apps cannot run a local extension.
The extension file `daysight-mcp-<version>.mcpb`	Download it from daysight.dev (Install page). It contains no secrets. Check it against the SHA-256 value shown there.
Your own **Workday API Client**	You register it in Workday (section 2). Ask your Workday administrator if you lack the permission.
A web browser	The Workday sign-in page opens there and sends you back to your own computer.
A **free port** on your PC while you sign in (3000 by default)	The sign-in callback listens at `https://localhost:<port>/callback` for a moment. You can use any free port, as long as the Redirection URI in Workday and the setting in Claude Desktop or ChatGPT use the same one. If another program uses it, see Troubleshooting.

> **Privacy and safety.** Whatever your assistant retrieves is sent to the AI provider as part of the conversation. For HR data, use **Claude Enterprise**, which does not use your conversations to train models, and check your company's policy on sending HR data to an AI service. Start on a sandbox or implementation tenant.

How access works

1. **The API Client sets the outer limit.** When you register it you choose its scopes (functional areas such as Staffing). DaySight MCP can only reach what those scopes allow.
2. **You set what comes back.** You sign in to Workday as yourself, so Workday applies your own security permissions to every request. A manager sees their reports, a regular employee does not.

The assistant never sees your client secret or tokens. There is no "call any URL" tool: it can only use the specific Workday operations DaySight MCP offers.

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2. Register your own Workday API Client

Do this once, in Workday. Your Workday administrator can do it with you. Task names below are the standard ones; labels can differ a little by tenant and release. If a label does not match your screen, search for the task name in Workday.

Register the client

1. In Workday, search for the task **Register API Client** and open it. Use this task, not the similarly named one for Integrations.
2. Enter a recognizable **Client Name**, for example `DaySight MCP`.
3. Set **Client Grant Type** to **Authorization Code Grant**.
4. Tick **Support Proof Key for Code Exchange (PKCE)**. With PKCE you **do not need a client secret**.
5. Set **Access Token Type** to **Bearer** and **Redirection URI** to `https://localhost:3000/callback`. You can use any free port instead of 3000: whatever you register here must be the same as the address you enter in Claude Desktop or the ChatGPT setup, including the port.
6. Choose the **Scope (Functional Areas)** (table below) and click **OK**.
7. Workday shows the **Client ID**. Copy it. If the form also offers **Non-Expiring Refresh Tokens**, tick it, so you do not have to sign in again each time the short-lived token expires.

> Because the client uses PKCE, there is no secret to store or protect. Tick **Use PKCE** in the extension and leave its client secret empty.

Choose scopes

Start small and add areas later (after a change of scopes, sign in again). The extension's default is `staffing organizations_and_roles`, which covers workers and organizations.

SCOPE IDENTIFIER	COVERS
`staffing`	Workers, direct reports, history, business titles, job and organization assignments. Start here.
`organizations_and_roles`	Organizations, supervisory organizations, organization types. Start here.
`time_off_and_leave`	Time off plans and entries, balances, leaves of absence.

`performance_enablement`	Goals, feedback, performance reviews, check-ins.
`worker_profile_and_skills`, `career_and_development_planning`, `talent_pipeline`	Skills, development items, mentorships, succession plans, prospects.
`recruiting`, `advanced_compensation`	Job postings, interviews, compensation scorecards. Sensitive: only if you need them.
`jobs_positions`, `contact_information`, `tenant_non_configurable`	Job families and profiles, contact information changes, inbox tasks and currencies.
`benefits`	Benefit plans and benefit elections, including employer contributions (for example for total rewards). Sensitive: only if you need it.
`core_payroll`	Pay slips. Sensitive: only if you really need it.

Workforce analytics uses Workday Query Language (WQL), so the API Client must also be allowed to use it. Ask your Workday administrator which areas and data sources your tenant requires. The exact scope spelling in your tenant is shown in the **View API Client** report; copy it from there. If sign-in answers *invalid scope*, a scope is misspelled or not ticked on the client.

Collect the values you need

Run the report **View API Client**, open your client and copy:

VALUE	LOOKS LIKE (EXAMPLE, NOT REAL)
Client ID	a long random string
Authorization Endpoint	`https://<tenant host>.myworkday.com/<tenant>/authorize`
Token Endpoint	`https://<services host>/ccx/oauth2/<tenant>/token`

The authorization host usually differs from the services host, so always copy both from the report. If you changed security permissions, run **Activate Pending Security Policy Changes** before you test.

3. Install in Claude Desktop

1. Download `daysight-mcp-<version>.mcpb` from daysight.dev and save it where you can find it, for example Downloads.
2. In Claude Desktop open **Settings > Extensions > Advanced settings > Install Extension** and pick the file. **Use this route.** Double-clicking the file or dragging it into the window does not work.
3. Review the extension details and confirm the installation.
4. Fill in the form with the values from your own API Client (table below).
5. Switch the extension **on**, then quit and reopen Claude Desktop.

6. Use it from the **Chat** tab (not the Code tab) and start a **new chat**. Click **+**, then **Connectors**, and check that the DaySight MCP connector is on.

FORM FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Client ID	From the API Client.
Client Secret	Leave empty (a PKCE client has none).
Authorization Endpoint	From View API Client.
Token Endpoint	From View API Client. The tenant and API address are taken from it.
Redirection URI	Default `https://localhost:3000/callback`. If you registered another port in Workday, enter exactly that address. It must match the API Client exactly.
Scopes	Space-separated scope identifiers from section 2.
Use PKCE	**Tick it.** The API Client has Support Proof Key for Code Exchange ticked.
Licence key	Leave empty during the 30-day trial.

Leave all other settings at their defaults unless your organization has decided otherwise. To change a value later, go to **Settings > Extensions**, update the form, then quit and reopen Claude Desktop and start a new chat.

Updating? Install the new file the same way. If Claude Desktop does not accept the file over the old install, remove the old extension first and enter the form again.

4. Install in the ChatGPT desktop app

The ChatGPT desktop app has its own setup program, **DaySightMCP-Setup-<version>.exe**. It asks for your Workday API Client details, sets up everything DaySight MCP needs and adds it to the app's MCP configuration. You do not need to install Node.js, use a command window or edit a file. ChatGPT in the browser and the phone apps cannot use a local DaySight MCP.

> Check with your workspace administrator that local MCP servers are allowed in your ChatGPT plan. The ChatGPT desktop app sends tool results to OpenAI, not Anthropic, so use data you are allowed to send there. Menu names in ChatGPT change between releases: check them on your screen.

What you need

- The ChatGPT desktop app, signed in.
- The setup file, downloaded from daysight.dev (Install page). Windows may show a warning for a file from the internet: check the publisher and the SHA-256 value on the Install page before you continue.
- The values from your Workday API Client (section 2): Client ID, Authorization Endpoint, Token Endpoint, the callback port you registered, and the scopes.

Steps

1. Close the ChatGPT desktop app if it is open, then run `DaySightMCP-Setup-<version>.exe`.
2. **Workday client:** enter the Client ID, the Authorization Endpoint and the Token Endpoint from View API Client.
3. **Sign-in:** leave **Client secret** empty (a PKCE client has none; PKCE is switched on automatically). Enter the **Callback port** you registered in Workday: the page shows the full address, for example `https://localhost:3000/callback`, which must match the Redirection URI of your API Client exactly. Check the scopes.
4. **Data and tools:** keep the privacy options at their defaults unless your organization has decided otherwise, and leave the licence key empty during the trial.
5. Click **Install**. The setup uses the Node.js already on your PC or the copy it carries, unpacks DaySight MCP into your user folder, saves your answers in a private settings file and adds a `daysight` entry to the app's MCP configuration (after making a backup copy of that file).
6. On the last page, follow **Next**: quit the ChatGPT desktop app completely (tray icon, Quit), reopen it and start a **new chat**. Then sign in as described in section 5. If DaySight does not appear, open **Settings** in the app and look for `daysight` in the MCP servers section.

To change a setting later, run the setup again: it offers your saved answers. To update, run the newer setup file. To remove DaySight MCP, use **Uninstall DaySight MCP** in the Start Menu or **Apps & Features**. This removes the entry from the app's configuration (after a backup) and the settings file; your Workday sign-in token stays until you ask your assistant to call `workday_logout`.

> **One client at a time.** Claude Desktop and ChatGPT share your sign-in folder by default. Use one at a time. Workday allows one redirect address per API Client, so if you use both, give both apps the same callback port, or register a second API Client for the second app.

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5. Sign in and ask your first questions

Make sure the callback **port is free** (3000 unless you chose another), then:

1. In a new chat ask: *"Call workday_login."* Allow the tool if your assistant asks.
2. Your browser opens the Workday sign-in page. Sign in as **yourself** and approve the API Client. If nothing opens, copy the address your assistant shows into your browser.
3. Workday sends you back to your callback address (by default `https://localhost:3000/callback`). Your browser warns once about the local certificate: continue to `localhost`. This stays on your computer.
4. Ask: *"Call workday_auth_status."* It should say you are signed in. Your login is stored encrypted in your Windows profile and refreshed automatically, so you normally sign in once.

The sign-in window waits 90 seconds. If you were too slow, ask for `workday_login` again. `workday_logout` removes the stored login.

Questions to try

- "Show the board scorecard."
- "Headcount, hires and exits by quarter for the last two years."
- "Turnover by function for Germany only."
- "Build a one-page workforce dashboard for the board."

Answers depend on the scopes of your API Client and on your own Workday permissions. More examples are on daysight.dev under Examples.

6. Trial period and licence key

The download is a free **30-day trial** for each Workday tenant, counted from the first time you use it. A new API Client on the same tenant does not restart the 30 days. The trial check runs on your computer, stores only a hash of your tenant name, and sends nothing anywhere.

1. When the trial ends, your assistant says so and shows a **request code**. It is a hash, not your tenant name.
2. Email the code to **contacts@daysight.dev** (or use the Contact page on daysight.dev). You receive a quote and, once it is agreed, a **licence key** for your tenant.
3. Paste the key into the **Licence key** setting (Claude Desktop: the extension form; ChatGPT: run the setup again and enter it on the Data and tools page). Quit and reopen the app and start a new chat.

Nothing in Workday is changed when the trial ends. By installing or using DaySight MCP you accept the **DaySight MCP Licence Agreement** at daysight.dev/license.html.

7. Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
The extension will not install	Use **Settings > Extensions > Advanced settings > Install Extension**. Update Claude Desktop to the current version. If you are updating, remove the old extension first.
Tools are missing, or the assistant says there is no `workday_auth_status` tool	In Claude Desktop use the **Chat** tab, not the Code tab, and start a **new chat**. Check the extension is switched on and the required form fields are filled in. In ChatGPT, quit the app completely (tray icon, Quit), reopen it, start a new chat and check that `daysight` is listed in its MCP servers settings.
`Missing configuration: ...`	A required field is empty. Fill in Client ID, Authorization Endpoint, Token Endpoint and Redirection URI.
Browser warns about the certificate	Expected once for the local callback address (`https://localhost:<port>`). Continue to localhost.

Sign-in fails, hangs, or the browser cannot connect to `localhost`	The callback port must be free during sign-in (see below). Close the program that uses it and ask for `workday_login` again. If you cannot free it, use another free port: register that redirect address on your API Client, for example `https://localhost:3100/callback`, and enter exactly the same address in Claude Desktop or the callback port in the ChatGPT setup.
invalid scope at sign-in	A scope is misspelled or not ticked on the API Client. Copy the spelling from View API Client.
A tool answers 403 / permission denied	Either the scope is missing on the API Client (add it, then `workday_logout` and `workday_login`), or your Workday security groups lack the access that tool needs.
Asked to sign in again every hour	The API Client does not keep refresh tokens. If the client has a **Non-Expiring Refresh Tokens** option, tick it and sign in again; otherwise ask your Workday administrator about the client's token settings.
Session expired and could not be refreshed	Ask for `workday_login` again.
The 30-day trial has ended	See section 6.

Check what is using the port

In PowerShell run:

```
netstat -ano | findstr :3000
```

Replace 3000 with your callback port if you chose another.

If a line shows `LISTENING`, the last number is the process ID. Find the program with `Get-Process -Id <PID>` and close it normally. A sign-in left waiting also holds the port for up to 90 seconds.

8. Security checklist and help

- Register your **own** API Client and never share its secret. Never post the client ID or secret in chat, email, tickets, screenshots or Git, and never share the files in `%USERPROFILE%\.daysight-mcp\`. If a secret is exposed, regenerate it in Workday.
- Give your API Client the smallest set of scopes that covers your questions.
- Keep the privacy settings at their defaults unless your organization has decided that individual-level HR data may go to the AI provider.
- Test on a sandbox or implementation tenant first.
- Use **Claude Enterprise**, which does not use your conversations to train models, and check your company's policy on sending HR data to an AI service.
- The extension keeps the client secret in secure storage and the login token encrypted in your user profile. It has no telemetry.

Help and legal

Questions or something not working? Write to **contacts@daysight.dev** or use the Contact page on daysight.dev. Tell us what you asked, what you expected and what happened. Please do not send client secrets, tokens or real employee data.

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